The unspecialised (22, 7) system does not refute at degree 4

These are the results of `research/dreg_closure_null22_7_20261028/`; the full text is in `RESULTS.md`. **Class:** stage diagnostic.

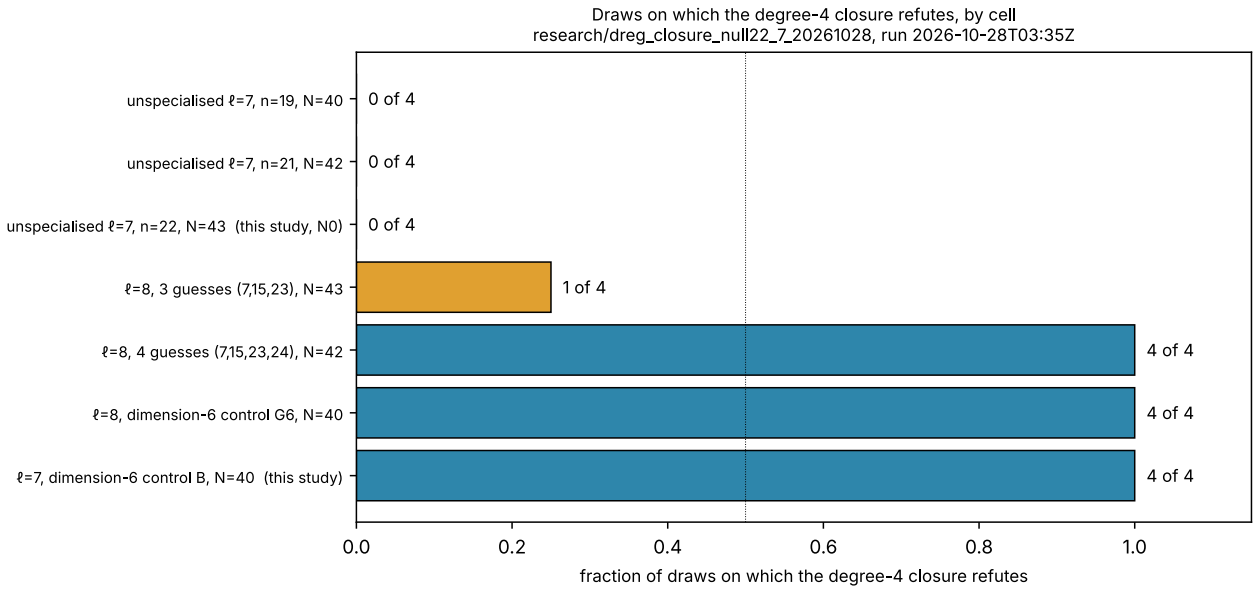

Figure 1: Draws on which the degree-4 closure refutes, by cell. Run 2026-10-28T03:35Z.

- **Registered verdict: N0 does not refute on at least 3 draws, the pure ℓ = 7 reading.** The unspecialised (22, 7) system, with the same 43 unknowns and 136,698 columns as the three-guess set, saturates degree 4 without the constant 1 on 4 of 4 draws. Controls valid (identity, dimension-6 positive, satisfiable soundness).
- **With the earlier cells,** 12 of 12 unspecialised ℓ = 7 draws do not refute, over N = 40, 42, 43 and surplus −2, 0, +1. The surplus confound is not what produced the earlier ℓ = 7 failure.
- **Relation to the three-guess set:** it failed on 3 of 4 draws and refuted on one. With four draws each, 3 of 4 and 4 of 4 are not distinguishable. The two cells are an analogy, not an identity.
- **ECC2K-130 (derived):** the three-guess failure is what ℓ = 7 does. The pattern fits `m·(ℓ−7)+1` guesses, 4 at ℓ = 8, and 105 at the priced m = 4, ℓ = 33 cell against a break-even of 6. That rests on ℓ = 7 and ℓ = 8 and is an extrapolation. No row moves, and none beats rho.
- **Next:** a three-variable set that leaves one summand at dimension 8, which this reading predicts will fail; a degree-5 closure at ℓ = 7 needs a larger host.